

IMEN266 — Using AI in this course

One page. Read it once; it applies all semester.

The deal

AI assistants are **allowed and encouraged** for studying, coding, and homework Parts B–D — and **absent** from exams, which are closed-book and count for 80% of your grade. So the only strategy that works is: *use AI to become someone who doesn't need it in the exam room*. Every class-problem notebook checks answers against *both* analytic formulas and simulation; let that agreement, not an AI's confidence, be your ground truth.

Three tutor modes that actually build skill

Copy-paste and adapt (each Companion proof ships with ready-made cards):

- **Socratic:** Quiz me step by step on [topic/proof]. One question at a time. If I'm wrong, give a hint, not the answer.
- **Adversarial:** Here is my solution: [...]. Attack it. Find wrong steps, hidden assumptions, and edge cases.
- **Reconstruction:** I'll state the theorem; you ask me the minimal questions I need to rebuild the proof myself.

Weak mode (avoid as a habit): "solve this for me" — it feels like progress and transfers nothing to the exam.

Homework norms (HW Parts A–D)

- **Part A:** first attempt alone, on paper, closed-book style. AI only for checking afterwards. Some Part-A problems may reappear on exams.
- **Parts B–C:** AI collaboration expected; *you* are accountable for every claim you make. Verify by simulation where possible.
- **Part D:** log every meaningful AI interaction (prompt, output, what you verified or fixed). One sentence on where AI was least trustworthy. Homework is not collected — the log is your own audit trail.

Programming assignments

Same policy as before: AI-assisted coding is fine **with declaration** (which tool, for what). You must be able to explain any line you submit; "the AI wrote it" is not an explanation.

Honesty about AI (and yourself)

AI assistants confidently make base-rate errors, fake independence assumptions, and arithmetic slips — HW 1 Part B has you dissect a real example. If an AI answer disagrees with the notebook's analytic-vs-simulation check, trust the check and find out why.

Allowed	tutoring, proof reconstruction, code help (declared), critique, HW B–D
Required	declaration in programming assignments (HW is not collected; keep the Part-D log for yourself)
Not allowed	exams (closed-book); submitting AI output you cannot explain
